



We Give Thanks!



Saracoff Sentinel/Team Tijuana

Thanksgiving 2011



***We're Grateful For:**

-  **Elias** and his hard work developing Microfinance
-  **Volunteers!**
-  **Kathy's Parents &** other missionaries, great examples to us!
-  **Arnulfo's life**
-  **YOU & supporters** who are part of our team

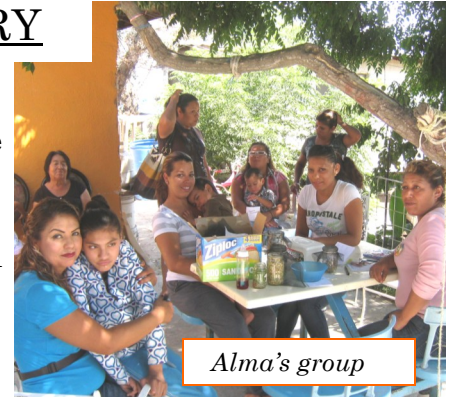
*A Saracoff tradition at Thanksgiving is to give each person 5 grains of corn. As we pass the basket, we tell 5 things we're grateful for this year.

Pray For:

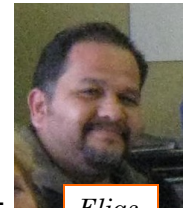
- Arnulfo's Family
- Alma and the groups
- God's provision of food and funds for each ministry to provide for their needs.
- Arturo (CdFe) facing major spinal surgery.

A MICRO-FINANCE STORY

This particular micro-finance group meets in the patio of a member's home under a shade tree. The members have known each other a long time and all has been progressing well with their loans...until a few weeks ago when one of their members was run over by a bus. Alma and her husband run a "granero" (feed store), but now she was in a coma. Should her loan be forgiven? What would become of the group that promised to support each other?



Alma's group



Elias

Elias, the director of our Micro-Finance group ("Mi Primero Negocio") challenged the group to rally. Meanwhile, he visited and prayed for Alma and her family at the hospital. The group members have not only made their own loan payments, but have covered Alma's as well. And Elias has had the privilege of sharing the love of God in both word and deed as he has prayed with Alma's sister. Other micro finance groups are praying for her also. We are all grateful to learn that Alma is out of intensive care and on the road to recovery

This is the same group that Josefina and Kathy visited a few months ago, with the goal of teaching them and their children about "Sprouts for Life"—how to grow sprouts and improve their family's nutrition. The children who were tagging along with their mothers loved tasting the sprouts! One of the mothers we met makes burritos and sells them at the schools to support her handicapped daughter (upper photo, front left, in blue). Pray for the success of these group, for Elias the leader of micro finance for Team Tijuana, and for Josefina as she follows up with the women.

OUR MISSION: To show the love of God to the poor and disadvantaged in Tijuana, Mexico, by raising funds to train, mentor and network. We do micro business and business development to raise standards of living. We fight the prevailing ambiance of corruption by teaching ethical excellence and hard work. We currently work with Carretas Community Center, Esperanza Rehab Center and Campamento de Fe.



Kathy's parents, Dr. Frank & Sally Dennis, shared life stories with Team Tijuana



Volunteers Karina & Sara from Vancouver help in weekly English class with Carretas niños

The KEY to the Satisfying Life by Dr. Frank Dennis

*On our way to Taiwan and China, Sally and I met with the leadership team and shared our purpose, how we had been asked by the Chinese Christian Medical Mission to come to encourage Chinese Christians to go to other countries to share their faith and show Christ's love by using their medical expertise to heal and to train locals. Many medical missionaries brought the Gospel to Taiwan over the last 150 years, but very few have gone **from** Taiwan to help other countries. In Ephesians 2:10 God reminds us that we are His workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which He has prepared in advance for us to do. (NIV) Every new Christian is like a blank key, made to open a lock but not yet "ground to fit" any particular lock. God will put every Christian through the experiences they need to do that "good work" He has prepared for them to do, but we must be Asking, Seeking and Knocking to find what door He wants us to open (Matt. 7:7) **This is the key to the satisfying life.** Because we opened a new Christian hospital in Taiwan in 1970, I have an open door to speak in Taiwan about the needs of Africa and Islamic countries. Their medical training can be the key to meeting needs in countries where few can get even basic medical care. When they have shown Christ's love they can then tell about His love and be understood.*

Goodbye, Arnulfo



Grandson Leo & G'pa Army

We all prayed God would heal him. We prayed for his family. But Arnulfo Ortega, after a courageous battle with a cancerous tumor on his spinal column, died on November 4th at the age of 42. Arnulfo was our friend for over 20 years, one of the first people we knew when we started working with the squatter community of Grupo Mexico back in 1989. I remember doing a Bible study with his wife Carmen when I could hardly speak any Spanish and my Ian and her Tania were toddlers. It is hard to watch a friend die at a young age. Especially when he is constantly calling "Gregorio" for help in his hospital room, suffering the anguishes of death and the fact that his wife and children were not allowed to cross the border to be with him as he spent his last few hours on this side of glory. God's calling Arnulfo early was hard but none of us can question the results. He never made it back home after being taken to emergency in the States, but died in hospice in San Diego. Just one week before his death, his three oldest daughters, Tania, Carolina and Maria, became Christians at the Bible study in their home in Tijuana. A thousand years from now, we will all be dead and gone. But God's gift of eternal life to Army and his family, perhaps thanks to a tumor, will still be celebrated. Read his wife's and daughter's tributes at www.legacyfuneralcare.com



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Let us hear from you!

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